

Josh Persi

Data Scientist

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Data scientist with a passion I am a self-taught data scientist with a formal background in the biological sciences. My current work with the Canadian Food Inspection Agency involves leveraging government, industry, and open-source data to model pest risks to plant health in Canada.

Experience

2022 – Present SCIENCE SPECIALIST

Canadian Food Inspection Agency

- Provide analytics support to scientists and policy makers
- Perform descriptive, predictive, diagnostic, and prescriptive analyses
- Create reproducible reports, dashboards, and Shiny applications

2021 – 2021 FIELD BOTANIST

Toronto Region Conservation Authority

- Conduct biotic inventories of terrestrial and aquatic plants in the Toronto area
- Identify taxa using dichotomous keys, morphological features, and habitat

Education

2018 – 2020 MASTER OF SCIENCE

McGill University

Thesis: Elevational patterns in seed fates: experimental tests in the Rocky Mountains

2013 – 2017 BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCES

University of Guelph

Thesis: Influence of Arbuscular Mycorrhizal Fungi on Root Allocation and Morphology in Two *Medicago* Species

Skills

- Natural language processing
- Shiny apps
- Data visualization
- Machine learning
- Workflow orchestration
- Containerization
- Data engineering
- Environment management
- Dashboarding

Computer Languages

R 
HTML 
Docker 

Git 
Bash 
CSS 

SQL 
Python 
JavaScript 

Languages

English 
Native proficiency

French 
B-certified